



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: North Star Classical Christian School

School Website: <https://nsclassical.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

North Star Classical Christian School IL 60030 demonstrates a robust alignment with the classic six-element rubric for classical education. Public-facing materials consistently foreground the three liberal arts tools of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Christian/theological integration, formation of intellectual virtues, and a governance/teaching culture that positions faculty as the living curriculum and parents as partners in a classical education. Across categories, the school's materials emphasize virtue, truth, and beauty, sustained through a Gospel-centered worldview, contemplative pedagogy, Socratic inquiry in upper grades, and parent involvement as co-educators. This strong confluence of catechetical mission, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty emphasis, and community engagement supports a classification of CLASSICAL for all six categories, with no category evidencing a clear move toward not-classical or only somewhat-classical.

Key evidentiary threads include: a mission anchored in the Gospel with explicit emphasis on formation of the soul and intellectual virtues; a curriculum built on grammar, logic, and rhetoric with references to a classical method and the existence of a senior/thesis-oriented capstone; pedagogical practices that mix contemplative/restful learning with Socratic discussion and rhetoric training; faculty described as master teachers and the living curriculum; and a strong parent/communal partnership model that treats parents as co-teachers and invites ongoing involvement and formation. See mission statements and program descriptions emphasizing "Anchored in the hope of the Gospel, equipped by the classical method, prepared to lead and live wisely" and the Trivium framework, along with explicit references to Socratic discourse and rhetoric in upper grades.

- Category-level snapshot (summary): All six categories align with CLASSICAL criteria, with explicit textual anchors to transcendental truth, virtue, beauty, formation, and classical pedagogy. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle: Not required at this time given the CLASSICAL rating across categories. If desired, minor, non-normative enhancements could include explicit cross-grade articulation of Great Conversation/Great Books and a formal liturgical integration, though current materials already signal strong theology, worship-like community rhythm, and traditional forms of communal learning. No major changes are required to shift the classification.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: Mission and creed items foreground Gospel-centered learning, theology integrated into all disciplines, and God as the source of knowledge; references to liturgical or communal elements appear as part of a sacral learning culture. For example, North Star's mission explicitly anchors education in Gospel, with God as the source of knowledge and a view of truth, goodness, and beauty as central (Anchored in the Gospel; Equipped by the classical method; Prepared to lead and live wisely). Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include: Gospel, theology, God, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, sacred, wisdom, wonder, Logos, sacred tradition. Negative signals (from the rubric) such as secular relativism or value-neutral approaches are not present in the public materials. Estimated positive keyword presence far outweighs any negative signals (roughly 6–10 strong positive terms, 0

negative terms observed in the public materials). This supports CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The school explicitly binds education to faith, theological grounding, and transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) as real and knowable, with liturgical/community rhythms and a theology-infused worldview.

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: Formation of virtue and wisdom as primary aims; formation over information; attainment of truth, goodness, and beauty as real. Mission phrasing emphasizes soul and virtue formation and intellectual virtues; statements about observing and articulating goodness and truth, with an ultimate aim beyond mere college/career preparation. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, human flourishing, intellectual virtues, awe, wonder. Negative keywords (if any) are not evident in the public content. Estimated positives far outweigh negatives (high ratio, approaching full positive signal). This supports CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The school frames education as formation toward human excellence—virtue and wisdom—consistent with classical aims, with explicit rejection (in public materials) of purely workforce-driven goals.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit framing of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as core curriculum; discussion of history as a throughline rather than mere social studies; emphasis on “great books” and “great conversation” as part of the learning continuum; references to liberal arts and the formation of memory and understanding. Materials describe “the stages of grammar, logic, and rhetoric” and the use of masterful tools of learning. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium, Great Books, great conversation, liberal arts, history, memory work, formation through the arts, and classical pedagogy. Negative signals (e.g., project-based-only or social-studies-first framing) are not evidenced in public content. Estimated positive count high; negative count near zero. This supports CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The curriculum emphasis aligns with classical education’s core content areas and approach (Trivium, liberal arts, historical integration, Great Conversation themes).
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence: A blend of contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) with rigorous Socratic discussion in upper grades; lower grades feature singing/chanting and memory-based recitation; upper grades include seminars, debates, and rhetoric training; opportunities for senior-level rhetoric and thesis projects. Examples include references to Socratic discussion in Rhetoric School (9–12) and the practice of teaching through memory work and recitation in younger grades. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include Socratic, Scholé, rhetorical training, memorization/recitation, chanting, seminars, debates, senior thesis, and disciplined discourse. Negative signals such as experiential learning-only or project-based constructs without classical inquiry are not present. Estimated positives > negatives. This supports CLASSICAL. Why this rating: Pedagogy explicitly blends contemplative/restful learning with structured, active, dialogic, and rhetoric-focused forms of instruction appropriate to different grade bands.
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Faculty described as master teachers and mentors; living curriculum; faculty as core to the school; a portrait of teacher and student expectations; leadership and academic deanship structures referenced publicly; board leadership material and faculty bios indicate a professional, virtuous faculty model. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include master teachers, living curriculum, faculty as core, collegial culture, mentorship, character formation, and exemplars. Negative signals are not evident. Estimated positive counts are strong; negative signals absent. This supports CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The public-facing materials present a living, virtuous, and collaborative faculty culture that embodies the classical teacher-mentor ideal.
- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: The school emphasizes partnership with families as co-teachers; parent formation and equipping through book studies and gatherings; open campus and opportunities for visits; explicit language about family involvement in classical education. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, open campus, and parental engagement. Negative keywords indicating a consumer-centric or disengaged parent role are not present. Estimated positive counts high;

negative counts 0–1 at most. This supports CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The materials underscore strong, ongoing parental involvement and teacher-parent collaboration central to classical formation.

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

- Overall assessment: The North Star materials indicate a coherent, Gospel-centered, classical-education orientation across all six categories, with explicit use of Trivium-based curriculum, classical pedagogy, model faculty, and deep parent/community partnership. The combined evidence from the public-facing materials places the school firmly within CLASSICAL territory.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not required given the CLASSICAL ranking across all categories. If desired for director-level improvement (without changing the classification), the school could explicitly foreground a cross-grade “Great Books / Great Conversation” program across the K–12 spectrum and make more explicit ties to liturgical-communal practices in everyday routines (while preserving the current strong emphasis on worship and Gospel-centered formation).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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